



— OFFICIAL USER GUIDE

Getting started with *WorkMan*.

How to install and start the database, the Laravel backend and the React frontend — then a complete, screen-by-screen tour of the platform for clients, technicians and administrators.

Laravel 13 · PHP 8.3

React 19 · Vite

MySQL / SQLite

3 roles

What's in this *guide*

Part 1 gets the application running on your computer. Part 2 explains how to use it. Every entry is a clickable link.

PART 1 — SETUP & START-UP

- 1 About WorkMan
- 2 What you need to install
- 3 Getting the project
- 4 Step 1 — Start the database
- 5 Step 2 — Start the backend
- 6 Step 3 — Start the frontend
- 7 Everyday start-up checklist
- 8 Demo accounts
- 9 Optional: AI photo diagnosis
- 10 Troubleshooting

PART 2 — USING THE APPLICATION

- 11 Public pages, sign-up & login
- 12 The dashboard layout
- 13 Client guide
- 14 Technician guide
- 15 Administrator guide
- 16 A booking from start to finish

APPENDICES

- A Page & route map
- B Testing the API with Postman

CONVENTIONS USED

Buttons and menu items look like **Find a technician**. Commands you type in a terminal are shown in dark boxes; the `$` prompt is not typed. Lines starting with `#` are comments. Booking statuses look like

PENDING.

01

Setup & *start-up*

WorkMan is made of three pieces that run side by side. You start them in this order: the database, then the backend API, then the frontend website.

1. About WorkMan
2. What you need to install
3. Getting the project
4. Start the database
5. Start the backend
6. Start the frontend
7. Everyday checklist
8. Demo accounts
9. AI photo diagnosis
10. Troubleshooting

About WorkMan

WorkMan connects clients with verified local technicians and covers the whole service journey — not just a directory.



The three roles

Role	What they can do
Client	Search and filter technicians, view profiles, chat, book (manually or with the AI booking assistant), pay the transport fee, track the technician live, confirm completion, rate and review, save favourites, report issues.
Technician (called “provider” in the code)	Build a professional profile (services, prices, service areas, working hours), upload an ID for verification, switch availability on/off, accept or reject bookings, set transport fees, share live GPS location, mark jobs done, view service history.
Administrator	Approve or reject technicians, manage users (deactivate / reactivate), manage service categories, monitor bookings, moderate reviews and resolve reported issues.

How the pieces fit together

Piece	Technology	Address	Folder / role
Database	MySQL 8 / MariaDB (recommended) or SQLite	localhost:3306	Stores users, bookings, messages, payments, reviews...
Backend	Laravel 13 REST API (PHP 8.3+)	localhost:8000	backend/ — all endpoints live under /api
Frontend	React 19 + Vite single-page app	localhost:5173	frontend/ — the website you open in the browser

The browser only talks to the frontend at `localhost:5173`. Vite forwards (proxies) every request that starts with `/api` or `/storage` to the backend on port 8000, so no CORS setup is needed during development.

Browser → Frontend :5173 —/api→ Backend :8000 → MySQL :3306

What you need to install

Install these once. Check each one with the command in the last column.

Software	Version	Why	Check with
PHP	8.3 or newer	Runs the Laravel backend. Needs the extensions <code>pdo_mysql</code> (or <code>pdo_sqlite</code>), <code>mbstring</code> , <code>openssl</code> , <code>fileinfo</code> , <code>curl</code> .	<code>php -v</code> <code>php -m</code>
Composer	2.x	Installs the PHP libraries (Laravel).	<code>composer -V</code>
Node.js + npm	Node 20.19+ or 22.12+	Runs the React/Vite frontend (Vite 8 requires these versions).	<code>node -v</code> <code>npm -v</code>
MySQL / MariaDB	MySQL 8 or MariaDB 10.6+	The database server. The easiest way on Windows is XAMPP (includes MySQL/MariaDB and phpMyAdmin).	<code>mysql --version</code>
Git	any recent	Download the project.	<code>git --version</code>

TIP FOR WINDOWS USERS

Installing **XAMPP** (with PHP 8.3+) gives you both PHP and MySQL in one step. Add `C:\xampp\php` to your `PATH` so the `php` command works in any terminal, then install Composer from getcomposer.org and Node.js (LTS) from nodejs.org.

Getting the project

```
$ git clone https://github.com/NGA828/WorkMan.git
$ cd WorkMan
```

The repository contains:

```
WorkMan/
├── backend/   Laravel 13 API (PHP 8.3+)
├── frontend/  React 19 + Vite website
├── postman/   Postman collection to test the API
└── docs/     Screenshots and this user guide
```

Start the *database*

The backend needs a running database before it can create its tables. MySQL (or MariaDB) is the recommended option.

WHY MYSQL IS RECOMMENDED

The backend `.env.example` defaults to SQLite, but one migration (`2026_09_12_151000_expand_payment_statuses_for_escrow.php`) runs a MySQL-only `ALTER TABLE ... MODIFY ... ENUM` statement. On SQLite, `php artisan migrate` stops with an error at that file. Use MySQL/MariaDB to avoid this, or see “Option B” below.

Option A — MySQL / MariaDB (recommended)

1 Start the MySQL server

WINDOWS — XAMPP

1. Open the **XAMPP Control Panel**.
2. Click **Start** next to **MySQL**. It turns green and shows port `3306`.
3. (Optional) Click **Start** next to Apache too if you want to use phpMyAdmin.

MACOS / LINUX

```
# macOS (Homebrew)
$ brew services start mysql
# Ubuntu / Debian
$ sudo systemctl start mysql
```

2 Create an empty database called `workman`

Either open **phpMyAdmin** (`http://localhost/phpmyadmin`) → **New** → type `workman` → collation `utf8mb4_unicode_ci` → **Create**, or use the terminal:

```
$ mysql -u root -p
-- (XAMPP: the root password is empty, just press Enter)
mysql> CREATE DATABASE workman CHARACTER SET utf8mb4 COLLATE utf8mb4_unicode_ci;
mysql> EXIT;
```

3 Point the backend at MySQL

After you create `backend/.env` (Chapter 5, step 2), replace the two SQLite lines with:

```
DB_CONNECTION=mysql
DB_HOST=127.0.0.1
DB_PORT=3306
DB_DATABASE=workman
DB_USERNAME=root
DB_PASSWORD=          # empty on XAMPP; otherwise your MySQL password
```

GOOD TO KNOW

You do not create any tables by hand. Laravel creates all of them (users, bookings, payments, messages, reviews, sessions, cache, jobs...) when you run `php artisan migrate --seed` in the next chapter.

Option B — SQLite (file-based, no server)

SQLite stores the whole database in a single file, `backend/database/database.sqlite`, so there is no server to start. This is the default in `.env.example`:

```
DB_CONNECTION=sqlite
DB_DATABASE=database/database.sqlite
```

```
# create the empty database file (from the backend/ folder)
$ touch database/database.sqlite           # macOS / Linux
> type nul > database\database.sqlite      # Windows (cmd)
```

KNOWN LIMITATION

Because of the MySQL-only migration mentioned above, `php artisan migrate` will fail on SQLite until that migration is made database-aware (for example, skipping the `ALTER TABLE` when `DB::getDriverName() === 'sqlite'`). Use Option A unless that has been fixed.

Start the *backend*

The Laravel API runs on `http://127.0.0.1:8000`. Open a terminal in the project folder — this is **Terminal 1**.

1 Install the PHP dependencies

```
$ cd backend
$ composer install
```

2 Create the environment file

```
$ cp .env.example .env          # macOS / Linux / Git Bash
> copy .env.example .env       # Windows (cmd / PowerShell)
```

Now open `backend/.env` in a text editor and set the database lines as described in Chapter 4 (MySQL recommended). The other important values are already filled in:

Variable	Default	Meaning
<code>APP_URL</code>	<code>http://localhost:8000</code>	Where the API runs.
<code>FRONTEND_URL</code>	<code>http://localhost:5173</code>	Where the website runs (used for CORS).
<code>DB_*</code>	SQLite	Database connection — change to MySQL.
<code>AI_API_KEY</code>	<i>empty</i>	Optional — enables AI photo diagnosis (Chapter 9).

3 Generate the application key

```
$ php artisan key:generate
```

4 Create the tables and load the demo data

```
$ php artisan migrate --seed
```

This runs every migration in `database/migrations/` and then `DatabaseSeeder`, which creates the demo accounts (Chapter 8), service categories, technician profiles and sample bookings at every stage of the lifecycle.

5 Link the storage folder (for uploads)

```
$ php artisan storage:link
```

ID documents and booking photos are saved to `storage/app/public`. This command makes them reachable at `/storage/...` so administrators can open uploaded ID documents.

6 Start the API server

```
$ php artisan serve
INFO  Server running on [http://127.0.0.1:8000].
```

Leave this terminal open — closing it stops the backend.

CHECK THAT IT WORKS

Open `http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/health` in your browser. You should see a small JSON response with `"status": "ok"`. `http://127.0.0.1:8000/api/categories` should list the service categories (Plumbing, Electrical work, Carpentry, Gas delivery, Laundry).

Useful backend commands

Command	What it does
<code>php artisan migrate:fresh --seed</code>	Deletes every table, recreates them and reloads the demo data — a full reset.
<code>php artisan serve --port=8080</code>	Run on another port (then update the proxy in <code>frontend/vite.config.js</code>).
<code>php artisan route:list --path=api</code>	Lists every API endpoint.
<code>php artisan config:clear</code>	Reloads <code>.env</code> after you change it.
<code>php artisan test</code>	Runs the PHPUnit test suite.

Start the *frontend*

The React website runs on `http://localhost:5173`. Open a **second terminal** (Terminal 2) in the project folder; keep the backend terminal running.

1 Install the JavaScript dependencies

```
$ cd frontend
$ npm install
```

2 Check the environment file

`frontend/.env` already exists and contains a single line — you normally do not need to change it:

```
VITE_API_BASE_URL=/api
```

If the file is missing, copy it from `.env.example` (`cp .env.example .env`).

3 Start the development server

```
$ npm run dev

VITE v8.x ready in 250 ms
→ Local:   http://localhost:5173/
→ Network: http://192.168.x.x:5173/
```

4 Open the application

Go to `http://localhost:5173` in Chrome, Edge or Firefox and log in with one of the demo accounts from Chapter 8 (for example `client@workman.local` / `password`).

HOW THE FRONTEND REACHES THE BACKEND

`frontend/vite.config.js` proxies `/api` and `/storage` to `http://127.0.0.1:8000`. The server also listens on all network interfaces (`host: '0.0.0.0'`), so you can open the Network address on a phone connected to the same Wi-Fi — handy for testing live GPS tracking.

Other frontend commands

Command	What it does
<code>npm run build</code>	Builds an optimised production version into <code>frontend/dist/</code> .
<code>npm run preview</code>	Serves the production build locally for a final check.
<code>npm run lint</code>	Checks the code with ESLint.

Alternative: preview without PHP or a database (mock API)

If you only want to look at the interface, the frontend ships with a zero-dependency Node.js server that imitates the real API with the same demo data. Use it **instead of** the backend and database:

```
$ cd frontend
$ node dev/mock-api.mjs           # fake API on http://127.0.0.1:8000/api
$ node dev/mock-api.mjs --fresh   # same, but reset to the original demo data
# then, in another terminal:
$ npm run dev
```

The mock saves its state in `frontend/dev/.mock-state.json`. The screenshots in Part 2 of this guide were captured this way. Do not run the mock API and `php artisan serve` at the same time — both use port 8000.

Everyday start-up checklist

Installation is done once. After that, starting WorkMan each day takes three steps.

1 · DATABASE

Start **MySQL** in the XAMPP Control Panel (or `brew services start mysql / sudo systemctl start mysql`).

Skip if using SQLite.

2 · BACKEND

```
$ cd backend
$ php artisan serve
```

Keep this terminal open.

3 · FRONTEND

```
$ cd frontend
$ npm run dev
```

Open `localhost:5173`.

To stop everything, press `Ctrl + C` in each terminal and stop MySQL in XAMPP. After pulling new code, run `composer install + php artisan migrate` in `backend/` and `npm install` in `frontend/`.

Ports at a glance

Service	URL	Started by
Website (frontend)	<code>http://localhost:5173</code>	<code>npm run dev</code>
API (backend)	<code>http://127.0.0.1:8000/api</code>	<code>php artisan serve</code>
MySQL	<code>127.0.0.1:3306</code>	XAMPP / system service
phpMyAdmin (optional)	<code>http://localhost/phpmyadmin</code>	XAMPP Apache

Demo accounts

Created by `php artisan migrate --seed` (and by the mock API). The password for every account is `password`.

Name	Email	Role	Notes
Admin User	<code>admin@workman.local</code>	ADMINISTRATOR	Full platform management
Awa Diallo	<code>client@workman.local</code>	CLIENT	Has bookings at every stage — best account to explore
Jean Mbarga	<code>jean@workman.local</code>	CLIENT	Second client
Michael Kone	<code>michael@workman.local</code>	TECHNICIAN	Plumbing · verified
Fatou Ndiaye	<code>fatou@workman.local</code>	TECHNICIAN	Electrical · verified
Samuel Bate	<code>samuel@workman.local</code>	TECHNICIAN	Carpentry · verified
Eric Talla	<code>eric@workman.local</code>	TECHNICIAN	Gas · pending verification (not visible to clients)

TESTING SEVERAL ROLES AT ONCE

The login is stored in the browser, so one browser window = one account. To watch a booking move between a client and a technician in real time, use a normal window for the client and a private/incognito window (or a second browser) for the technician. Logging in again with the same account signs out its previous session.

Optional: AI photo diagnosis

In the **Book with AI** assistant, clients can attach a photo of the problem and ask for an AI analysis. This calls an external vision model from the backend.

Everything else works without it. To enable it, add a key to `backend/.env` and restart `php artisan serve`:

```
AI_PROVIDER=openrouter           # or: groq
AI_API_KEY=your-provider-key-here
AI_MODEL=google/gemini-2.0-flash-exp:free # any vision model
AI_CA_BUNDLE=storage/app/cacert.pem      # optional
```

KEEP THE KEY SECRET

The key belongs only in `backend/.env` — never in `frontend/.env` (anything starting with `VITE_` is sent to the browser). Without a key, the assistant shows “AI diagnosis is not configured”.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
<code>php</code> or <code>composer</code> is “not recognized”	Add PHP (e.g. <code>C:\xampp\php</code>) and Composer to your system <code>PATH</code> , then open a new terminal.
<code>composer install</code> complains about the PHP version or a missing extension	Use PHP 8.3+. Enable the missing extension (e.g. <code>extension=fileinfo</code> , <code>extension=pdo_mysql</code>) in <code>php.ini</code> .
<code>SQLSTATE[HY000] [2002] Connection refused</code>	MySQL is not running — start it in XAMPP. Check <code>DB_HOST</code> / <code>DB_PORT</code> in <code>.env</code> .
Unknown database 'workman'	Create the database first (Chapter 4, step 2).
Access denied for user 'root'	Set the correct <code>DB_USERNAME</code> / <code>DB_PASSWORD</code> , then run <code>php artisan config:clear</code> .
Migration fails with <code>near "MODIFY": syntax error</code>	You are on SQLite. Switch to MySQL (Chapter 4, Option A), then run <code>php artisan migrate:fresh --seed</code> .
No application encryption key has been specified	Run <code>php artisan key:generate</code> .
Login fails / the page shows network errors	The backend is not running on port 8000. Start <code>php artisan serve</code> and check <code>/api/health</code> .
“Your account has been deactivated”	An administrator deactivated this user. Reactivate it in <code>Users</code> , or reset the data with <code>migrate:fresh --seed</code> .
Port 5173 or 8000 already in use	Stop the other program (or an old terminal). Vite will offer the next free port automatically.
<code>npm run dev</code> fails with a Node version error	Upgrade Node.js to 20.19+ or 22.12+.
Uploaded ID documents give 404	Run <code>php artisan storage:link</code> .
The tracking map is grey	Map tiles come from OpenStreetMap — an internet connection is required. Allow location access when the browser asks.
The browser does not ask for location / sharing fails	Browsers only allow GPS on <code>localhost</code> or HTTPS. When testing on a phone via the Network IP, use an HTTPS tunnel.

02

Using the *application*

A screen-by-screen tour of WorkMan. Each role has its own dashboard and sidebar menu; start with the chapter for the role you are using.

11. Public pages, sign-up & login

12. The dashboard layout

13. Client guide

14. Technician guide

15. Administrator guide

16. A booking from start to finish

Public pages, sign-up & login

Anyone can see these pages without an account.

The home page — /

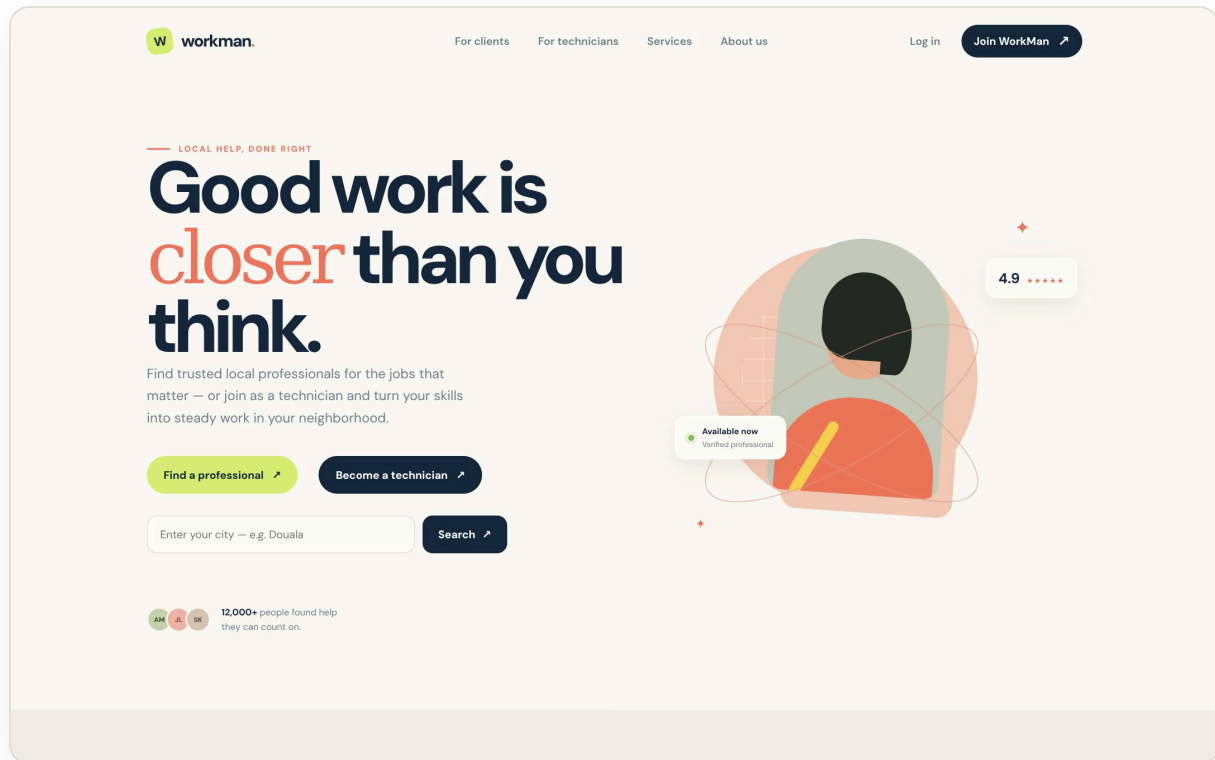
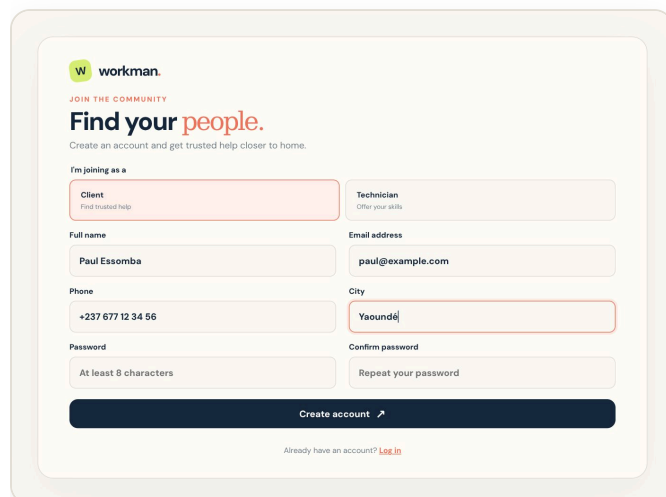


Figure 1. The WorkMan home page.

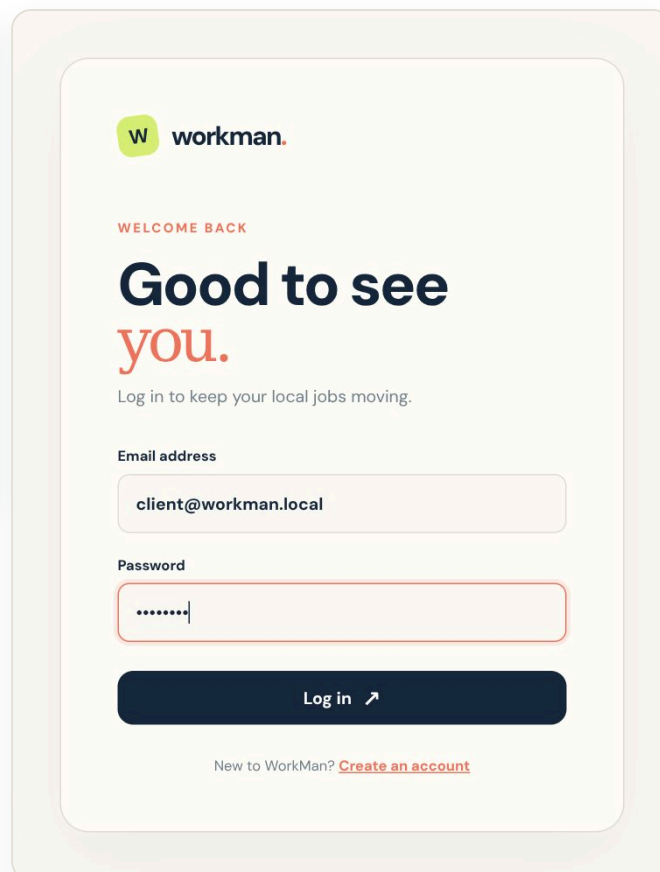
- **Top menu** — **For clients**, **For technicians**, **Services** and **About us** scroll to the matching section of the page.
- **Log in** opens the login page; **Join WorkMan** opens the registration page. When you are already logged in, the button becomes a link to your dashboard.
- **Find a professional** and **Become a technician** start sign-up for the matching role. The city search box lets visitors start looking for help in their city.
- Further down: the service categories, “How it works” and the trust & safety section.

Creating an account — /register



The registration form for WorkMan is titled "Find your people." and includes the subtext "JOIN THE COMMUNITY" and "Create an account and get trusted help closer to home." It features a "I'm joining as a" section with two radio buttons: "Client" (selected) and "Technician". Below this are fields for "Full name" (Paul Essomba), "Email address" (paul@example.com), "Phone" (+237 677 12 34 56), and "City" (Yaounde). A "Password" field is labeled "At least 8 characters" and a "Confirm password" field is labeled "Repeat your password". A "Create account" button is at the bottom, with a link "Already have an account? Log in" below it.

Figure 2. Registration with role choice.



The login form for WorkMan is titled "Good to see you." and includes the subtext "WELCOME BACK" and "Log in to keep your local jobs moving." It features a "Email address" field with the value "client@workman.local" and a "Password" field with masked characters ".....". A "Log in" button is at the bottom, with a link "New to WorkMan? Create an account" below it.

Figure 3. The login page.

1. Enter your **Full name**.
2. Under **I'm joining as a**, pick **Client** (find trusted help) or **Technician** (offer your skills).
3. Fill in your **email**, **phone** (e.g. +237 6XX XXX XXX) and **city**.
4. Choose a **password** of at least 8 characters and repeat it.
5. Click **Create account** . You are signed in and taken straight to your dashboard.

ADMINISTRATOR ACCOUNTS

You cannot register as an administrator from the website. Use the seeded `admin@workman.local` account.

Logging in — /login

Enter your email and password and click **Log in** . If you tried to open a dashboard page while signed out, you are sent back to that page after logging in. Use **← Back to WorkMan** to return to the home page, or **Create an account** to switch to sign-up.

The dashboard layout

After login every role works inside the same shell. Only the sidebar menu changes.

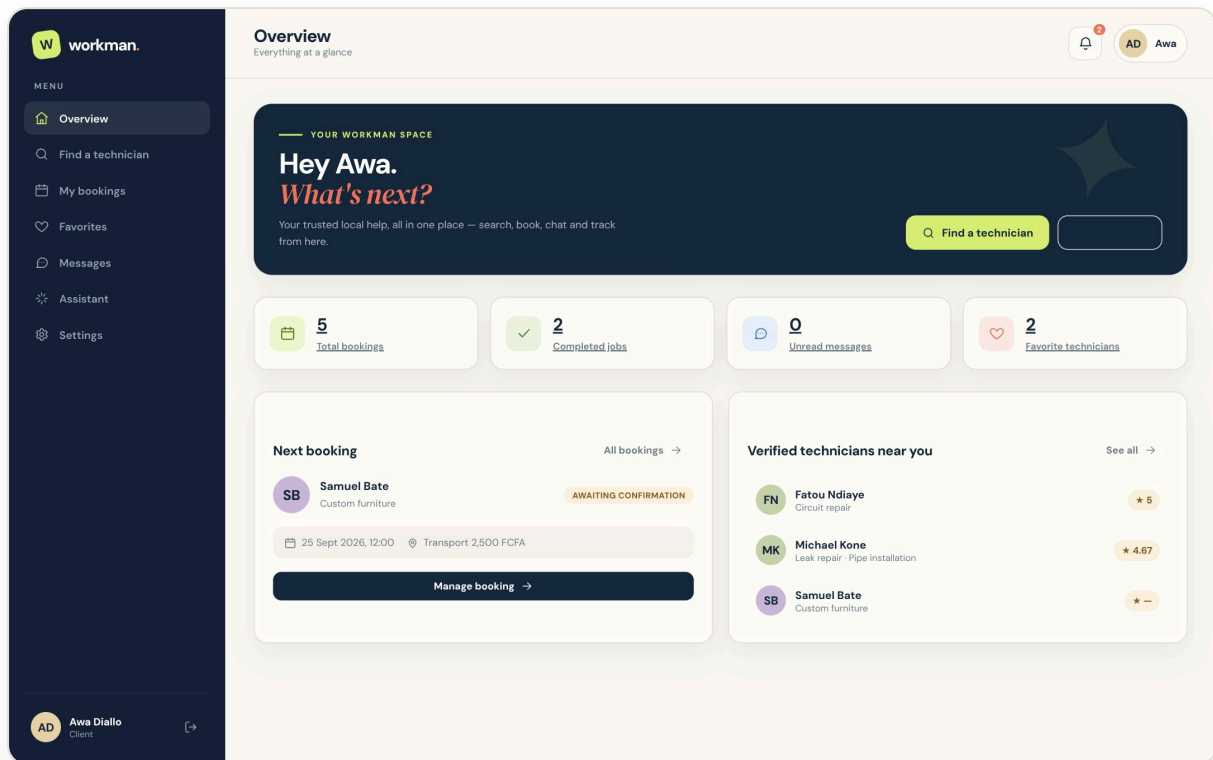


Figure 4. The dashboard shell (client view): sidebar on the left, top bar with page title, notification bell and your name.

① Sidebar (left)

- **Menu** — the pages available to your role. The current page is highlighted.
- **Your name and role** at the bottom.
- The **sign-out** icon (arrow) next to your name logs you out and returns to the home page.

② Top bar

- **Page title** and a short description.
- **Notification bell** — a red counter shows unread notifications.
- Your avatar and first name.
- On phones and small screens the sidebar is hidden: tap the **grid icon** at the top left to open it.

Notifications

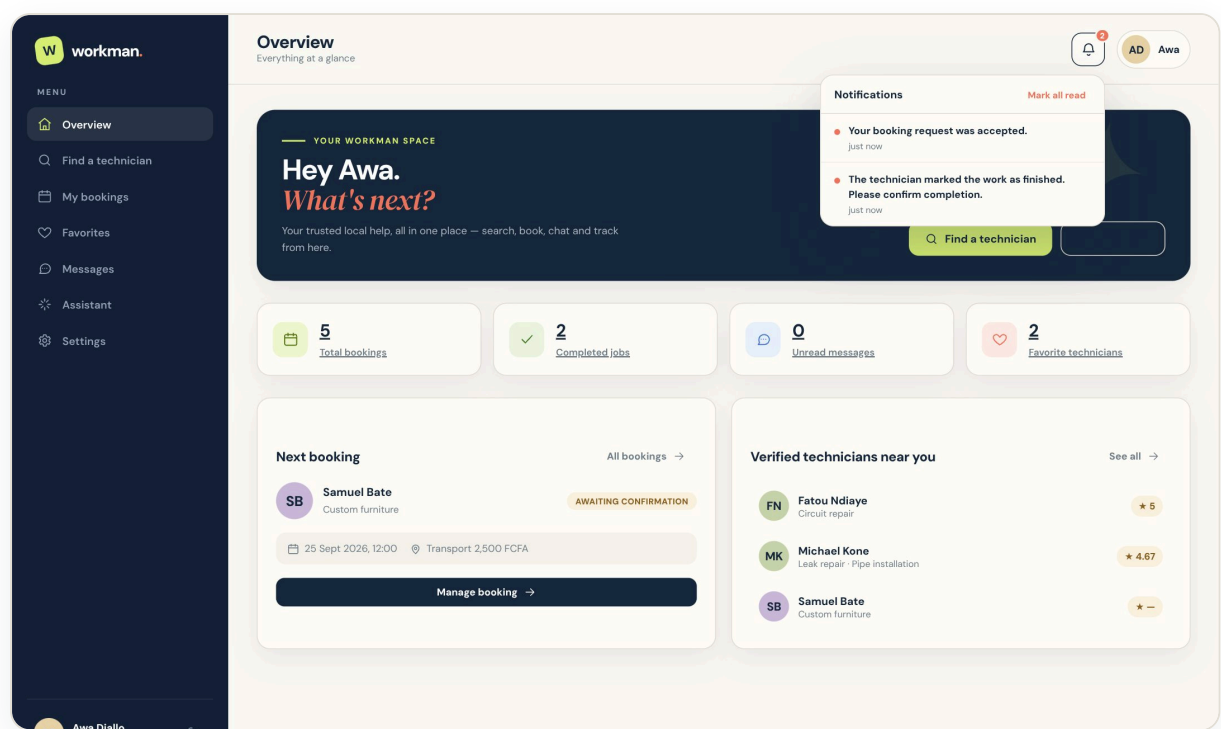


Figure 5. The notification panel opens from the bell.

Click the bell to see recent events — a booking was accepted, a payment was received, a new message arrived, a job was marked done, and so on. Click a notification to jump to the related page, or **Mark all read** to clear the counter.

Menus by role

Client	Technician	Administrator
Overview	Overview	Overview
Find a technician	Job requests	Verification
My bookings	Service history	Users
Favorites	Messages	Categories
Messages	Assistant	Bookings
Assistant	My profile	Reviews
Settings		Reports & issues

If you type the address of a page that belongs to another role (e.g. a client opening `/dashboard/jobs`), WorkMan sends you back to your own Overview.

Client *guide*

Find a verified technician, book, pay the transport fee, follow the technician and rate the job. Try it with `client@workman.local`.

13.1 Overview

The Overview (Figure 4) is your home page. It shows:

- **Four counters** — total bookings, completed jobs, unread messages and favourite technicians. Click any of them to open the matching page.
- **Next booking** — your upcoming appointment with its status, date and transport fee, plus [Manage booking](#).
- **Verified technicians near you** — quick links to top-rated professionals. [See all](#) opens the search.
- The [Find a technician](#) shortcut in the welcome banner.

13.2 Find a technician

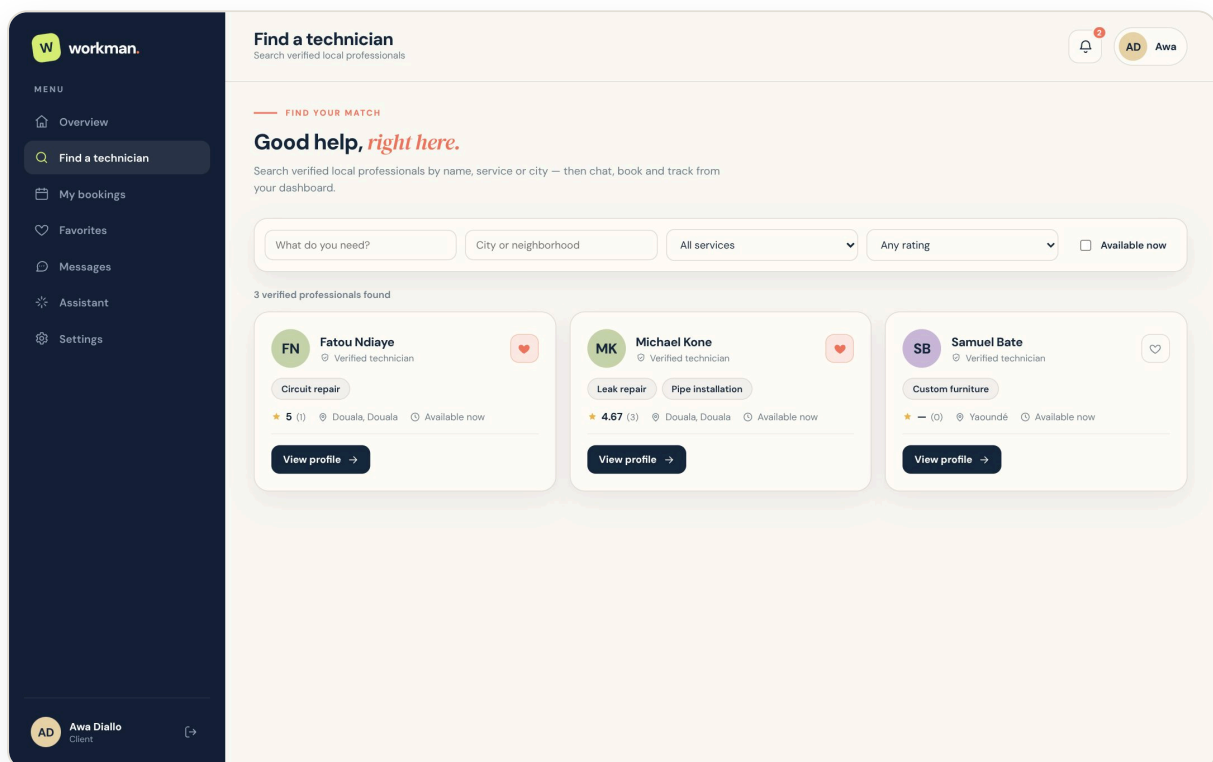


Figure 6. Search and filter verified technicians.

Open [Find a technician](#) in the sidebar. Only technicians approved by an administrator appear here. Combine any of these filters — the results update as you type:

Filter	Use it to...
What do you need?	Search by technician name or service (e.g. "leak", "Fatou").
City or neighborhood	Only show technicians who work in that area (e.g. Douala, Akwa).
All services	Limit to one category (Plumbing, Electrical work, Carpentry...).
Any rating	Show only technicians rated 3★, 4★ or 4.5★ and up.
Available now	Hide technicians who switched their availability off.

On each card, click the **heart** to save the technician to your favourites, or **View profile** to open the full profile.

13.3 Technician profile

workman.

Technician profile
Verified professional details

Michael Kone
Verified technician
Plumber with 8 years of experience fixing leaks, installing pipes and renovating bathrooms across Douala.

★ 4.67 (3) 8 Douala, Douala Available
Rating Years experience Service area Current status

Services & prices

Leak repair Fixing leaking pipes, taps and joints.	5,000 FCFA+
Pipe installation New pipe runs for kitchens and bathrooms.	15,000 FCFA+

Working hours

Sunday	Closed
Monday	08:00 – 18:00
Tuesday	08:00 – 18:00
Wednesday	08:00 – 18:00
Thursday	08:00 – 18:00
Friday	08:00 – 18:00
Saturday	08:00 – 14:00

Service areas

Douala — Akwa Douala — Bonamoussadi

Recent reviews

Awa Diallo
Very professional and arrived on time.
26 Sept 2026 ★★★★★

Jean Mbarga
Fixed the leak quickly. Highly recommend.
26 Sept 2026 ★★★★★

Figure 7. A technician's profile: verification badge, rating, services and prices, working hours, service areas and reviews.

The profile shows everything you need to decide: the **Verified technician** badge, bio, rating, years of experience, cities, availability, **services with starting prices**, weekly **working hours**, **service areas** and **recent reviews**. The action buttons at the top right:

- **♥** — add / remove from favourites.
- **Chat** — opens a private conversation with the technician in **Messages**. Use it to describe the problem before booking.
- **Book** — opens the booking form (13.4).
- **Book with AI** — lets the booking assistant prepare the request for you (13.5).

13.4 Booking a technician

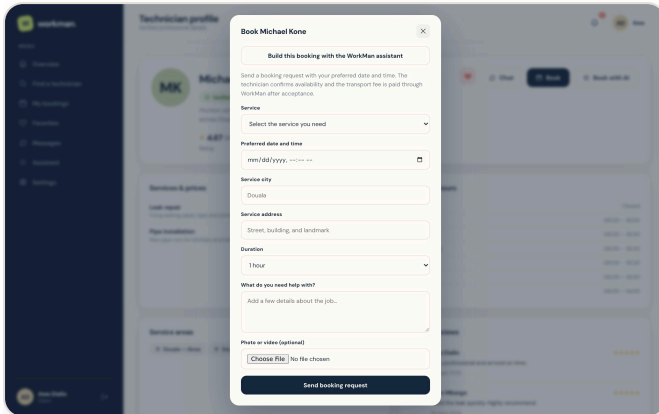


Figure 8. The booking form.

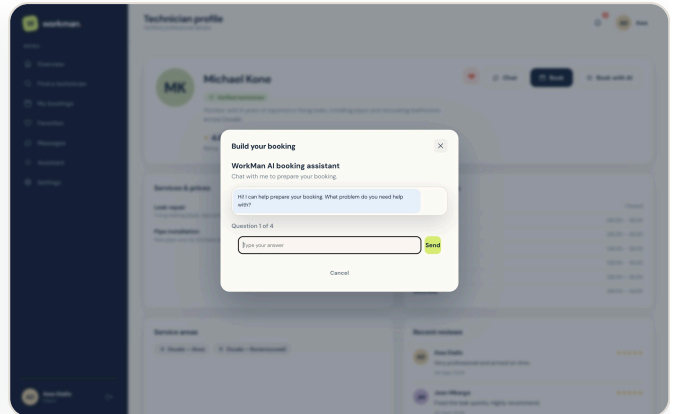


Figure 9. Building a booking with the AI assistant.

1. Click **Book** on the technician's profile.
2. Choose the **Service** you need.
3. Pick the **Preferred date and time**. It must fall inside the technician's working hours and not clash with another booking — otherwise you'll see an error explaining why.
4. Enter the **Service city** and **Service address** (street, building, landmark).
5. Choose the expected **Duration**.
6. Describe the job in **What do you need help with?** and optionally attach a **photo or video**.
7. Click **Send booking request**. The technician is notified and the booking appears in **My bookings** as **PENDING**.

HOW PAYMENT WORKS

You do not pay when you book. The technician sets a **transport fee** when they accept, and you pay it through WorkMan with mobile money. The **service price** itself is agreed after the technician has diagnosed the problem.

13.5 Booking with the AI assistant

Book with AI opens a short chat that asks four questions — **the problem, the address, when** you want the visit and **how urgent** it is. It then suggests the best matching service from that technician. You can attach a photo or video and click **Analyze image with AI** for a diagnosis (requires the AI key, Chapter 9). Click **Use this booking** to copy everything into the booking form, check it, and send it. **Start over** resets the conversation.

13.6 My bookings

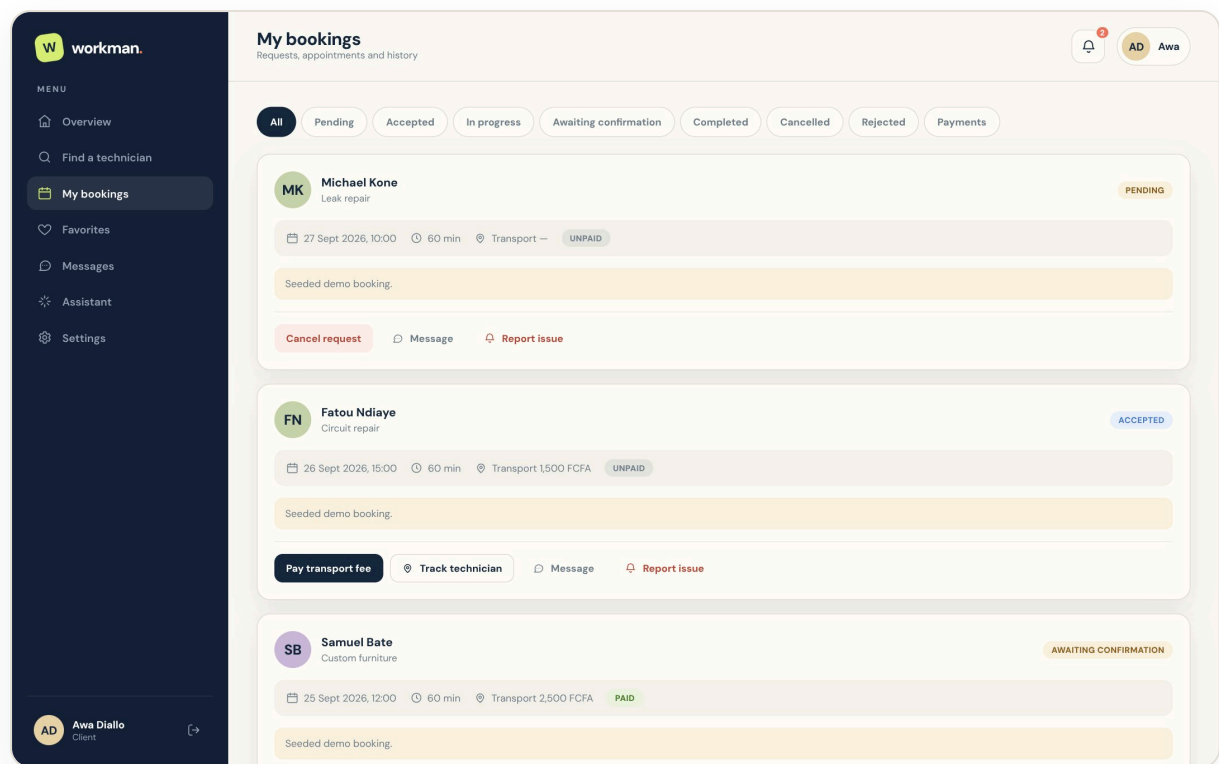


Figure 10. My bookings — each card shows the technician, service, date, duration, transport fee, payment status and the actions available right now.

Use the tabs at the top to filter by status: **All, Pending, Accepted, In progress, Awaiting confirmation, Completed, Cancelled, Rejected, and Payments** (your payment history). The buttons on each card change with the booking's status:

Status	What it means	Buttons you'll see
PENDING	Waiting for the technician to answer.	Cancel request
ACCEPTED	The technician accepted and set a transport fee.	Pay transport fee → then Release transport payment ; Track technician
IN PROGRESS	The technician has started the job.	Track technician
AWAITING CONFIRMATION	The technician marked the work as done.	Confirm completion
COMPLETED	You confirmed the job.	Star rating + review form; Pay service fee ; Clear booking
CANCELLED / REJECTED	You cancelled, or the technician declined.	Clear booking

Every card also has **Message** (chat with the technician) and **Report issue** .

13.7 Paying the transport fee (escrow)

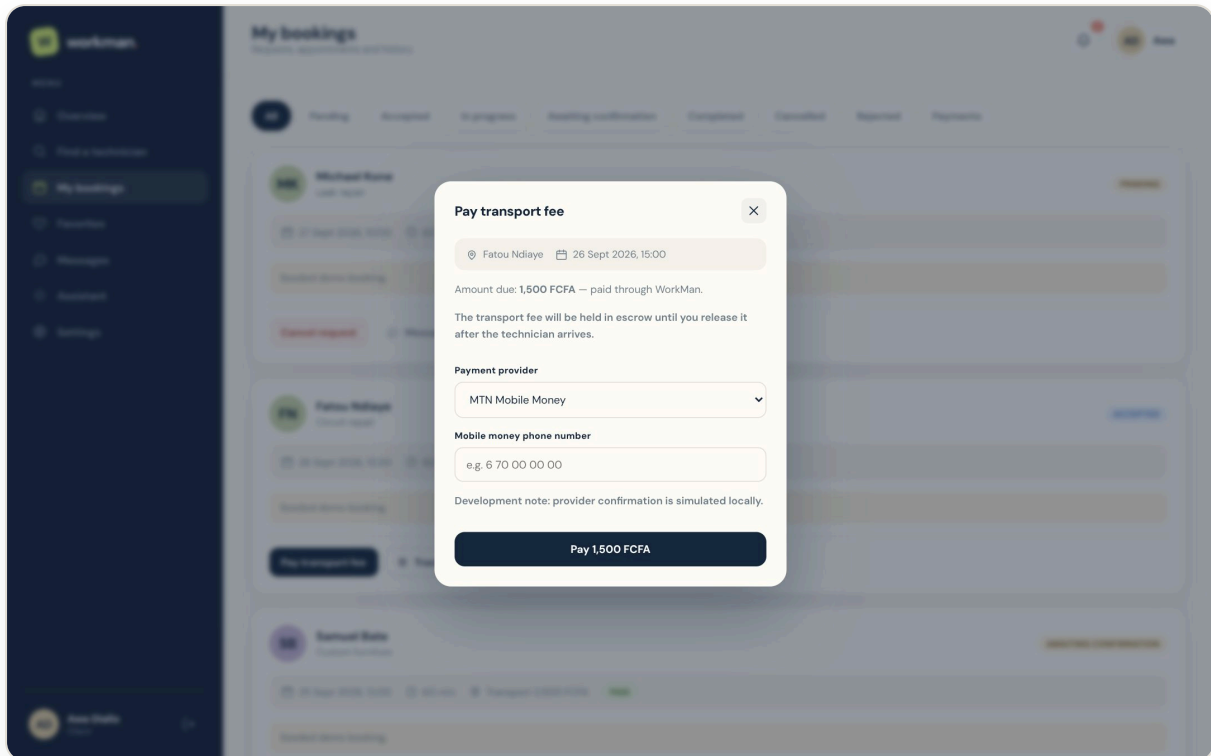


Figure 11. Paying the transport fee with mobile money.

1. On an **ACCEPTED** booking, click **Pay transport fee**.
2. Check the amount due, choose **MTN Mobile Money** or **Orange Money** and enter your mobile money number.
3. Click **Pay 1,500 FCFA** (the button shows the amount). The money is **held in escrow** by WorkMan — the technician can see it has been paid, but does not receive it yet.
4. When the technician arrives, click **Release transport payment**. The technician can now start the job.

DEVELOPMENT NOTE

In local development the mobile money confirmation is **simulated** — no real money moves. In production it would be confirmed by the MTN MoMo / Orange Money webhook. Never share your mobile money PIN in chat.

13.8 Live tracking

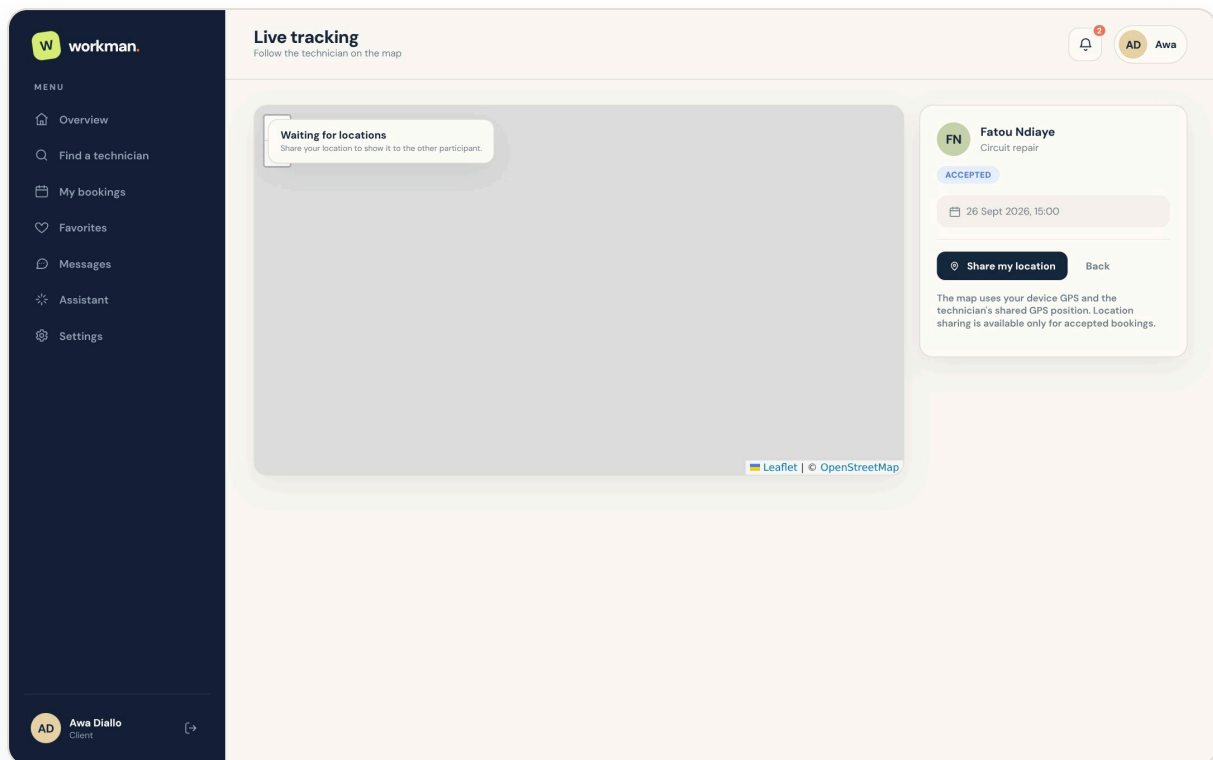


Figure 12. Live tracking. (The map is grey in this screenshot only because it was captured offline; with internet access, OpenStreetMap streets are shown with both positions.)

For **ACCEPTED** and **IN PROGRESS** bookings, click **Track technician**. The map shows the technician's shared GPS position and, if you click **Share my location** and allow the browser's location prompt, your own position — the badge then shows how many kilometres apart you are. Click **Stop sharing** at any time; sharing is only possible while the booking is active.

13.9 Confirming, paying the service and reviewing

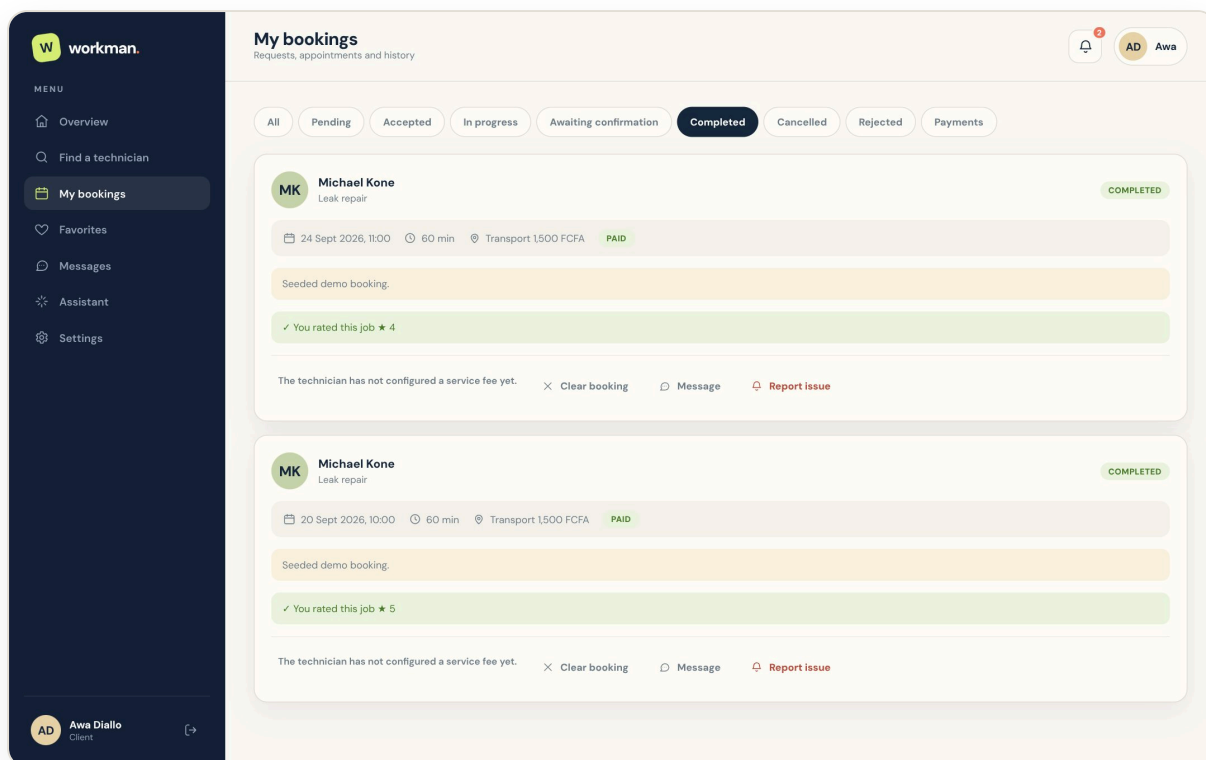


Figure 13. The Completed tab, with the review form and service payment.

1. When the technician marks the job done, the booking becomes **AWAITING CONFIRMATION**.
2. Check the work, then click **Confirm completion**. (If a transport fee exists, it must be paid and released first — the button stays disabled with a reminder until then.)
3. On the **COMPLETED** booking, click the **stars** (1–5), write a short comment and click **Submit review**. It appears on the technician's profile and updates their rating.
4. If the technician listed a starting price, **Pay service fee** lets you pay it through WorkMan the same way as the transport fee.

The **Payments** tab lists every transport and service payment with its status: **PENDING**, **HELD IN ESCROW**, **RELEASED** or **PAID**.

13.10 Reporting an issue

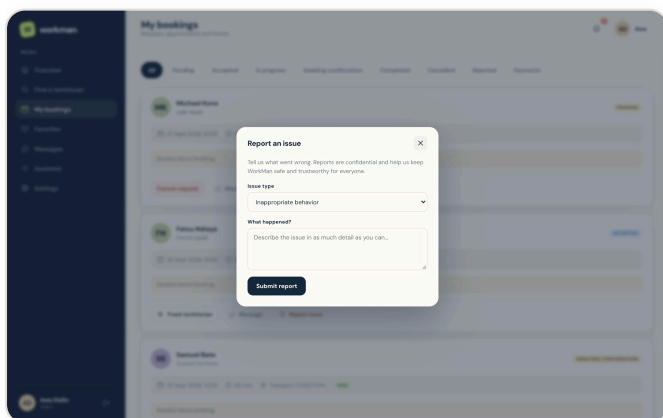


Figure 14. Report an issue.

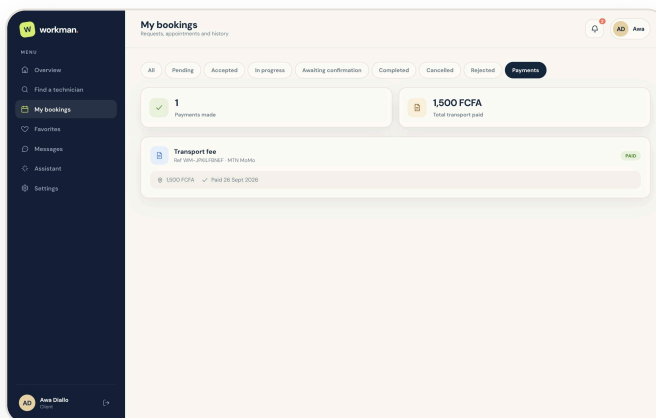


Figure 15. The Payments tab.

Click **Report issue** on any booking, choose the type — *Inappropriate behavior, Fake or misleading profile, Payment issue, No-show at appointment, Safety concern* or *Other* — describe what happened and submit. The WorkMan administrators receive it in **Reports & issues**.

13.11 Favorites

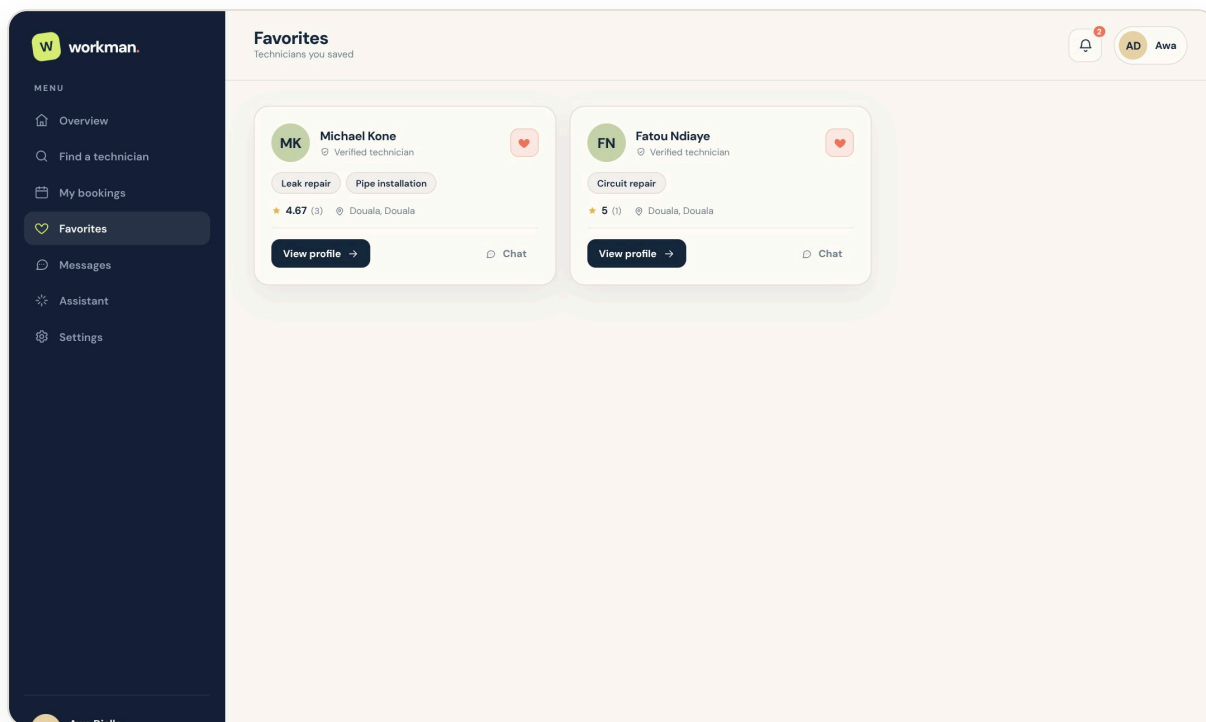


Figure 16. Saved technicians.

Every technician you hearted appears here with **View profile** and **Message** shortcuts. Click the heart again to remove them.

13.12 Messages

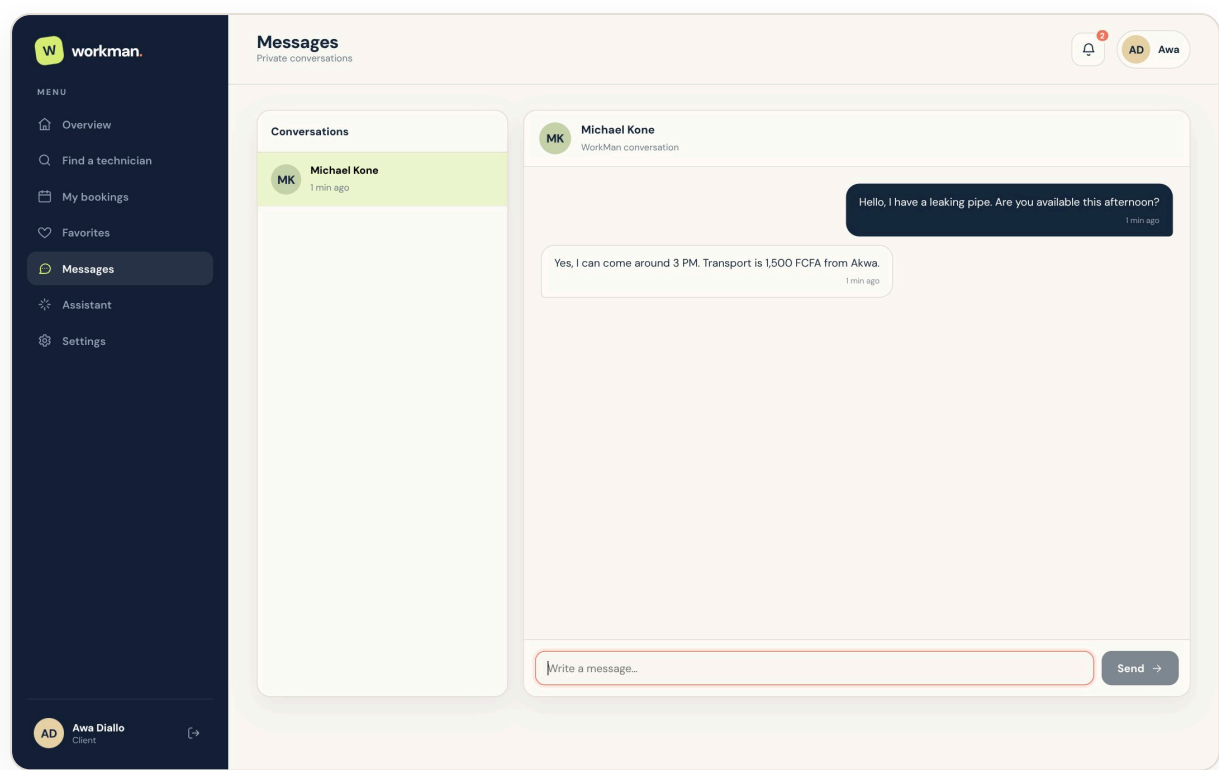


Figure 17. Private conversations between a client and a technician.

The left column lists your conversations; click one to read it. Type in **Write a message...** and press **Send** (or **Enter**). New conversations are started from a technician's profile (**Chat**), a favourite, or a booking (**Message**). Technicians use exactly the same page.

13.13 Assistant

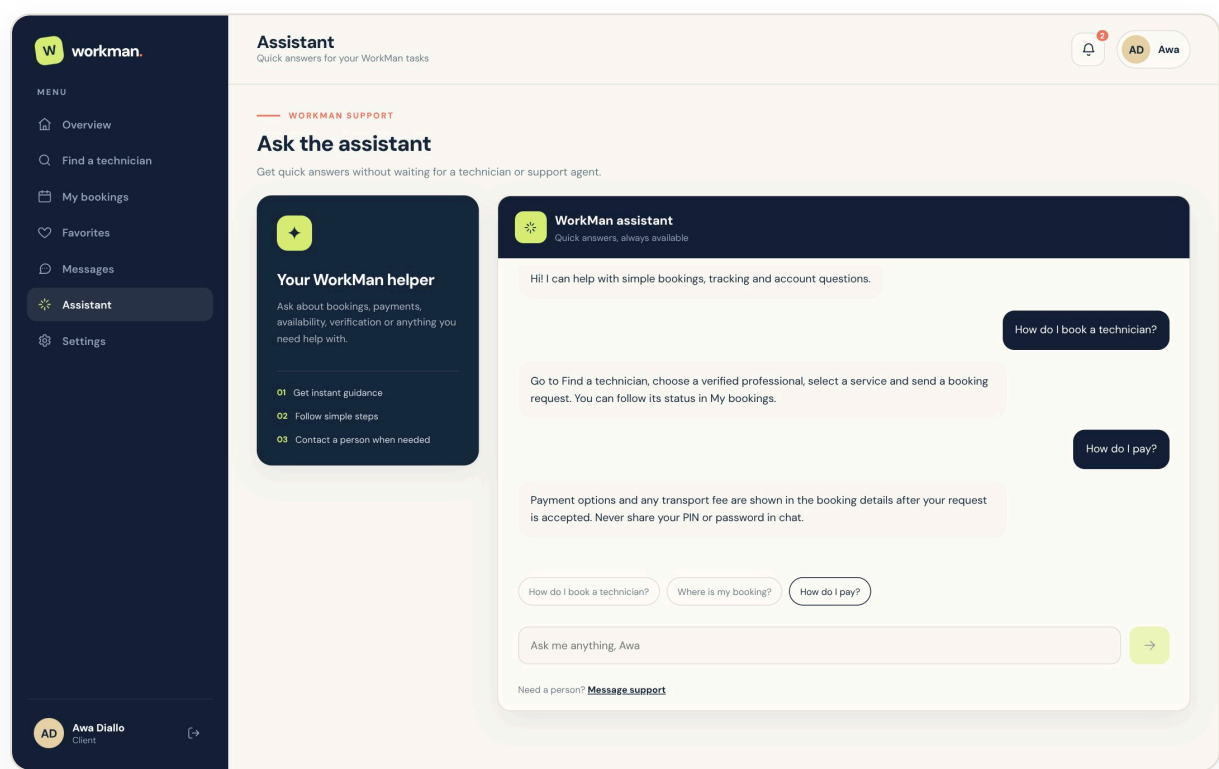


Figure 18. The WorkMan help assistant.

The **Assistant** page answers common questions instantly — how to book, where your booking is, how to pay, how to cancel. Click a suggested question or type your own. (Technicians get questions about accepting jobs, availability and verification.)

13.14 Settings & identity verification

The screenshot shows the 'Settings' page for a user named Awa Diallo. The page is divided into two main sections: 'YOUR INFORMATION' and 'IDENTITY VERIFICATION'. The 'YOUR INFORMATION' section contains fields for 'Full name' (Awa Diallo), 'Phone' (+237 655 12 34 56), 'City' (Douala), and 'Address' (Rue Joffre, Akwa). A 'Save changes' button is located below these fields. The 'IDENTITY VERIFICATION' section has a status of 'UNVERIFIED' and a message stating that national identity verification is required. It includes a prompt to 'Upload your National ID or Passport to verify your account.' and a file upload area for 'National ID or Passport photo (JPG, PNG, PDF up to 5MB)'. The upload area shows a 'Choose File' button and 'No file chosen'. An 'Upload ID document' button is also present. The left sidebar contains a menu with options like Overview, Find a technician, My bookings, Favorites, Messages, Assistant, and Settings. The bottom of the sidebar shows the user's profile as 'Awa Diallo Client'.

Figure 19. Personal information and identity verification.

- **Your information** — update your full name, phone, city and address, then click **Save changes**.
- **Identity verification** — upload a photo of your National ID card or passport (JPG, PNG or PDF, up to 5 MB) and click **Upload ID document**. The status changes from *Unverified* to *Pending* until reviewed.

Technician *guide*

Set up your professional profile, get verified, and manage jobs from request to completion. Try it with `michael@workman.local`.

14.1 Overview, verification status & availability

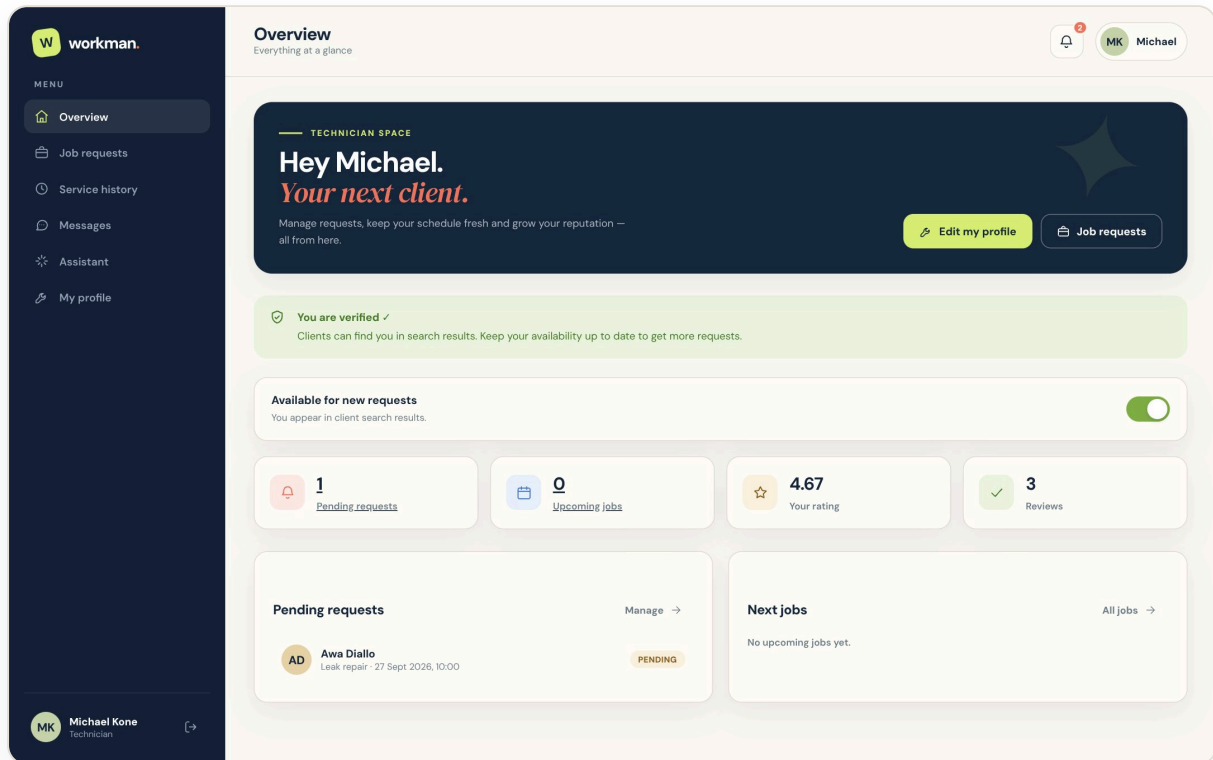


Figure 20. The technician Overview with verification banner and availability switch.

- The **verification banner** tells you where you stand: **PENDING** — you are not visible to clients yet; **VERIFIED ✓** — clients can find you; **REJECTED** — review your profile and contact the administrator.
- The **Available for new requests** switch controls whether you appear in client searches. Turn it off when you are busy or on leave.
- Counters for pending requests, upcoming jobs, your rating and number of reviews, plus lists of **Pending requests** and **Next jobs**.

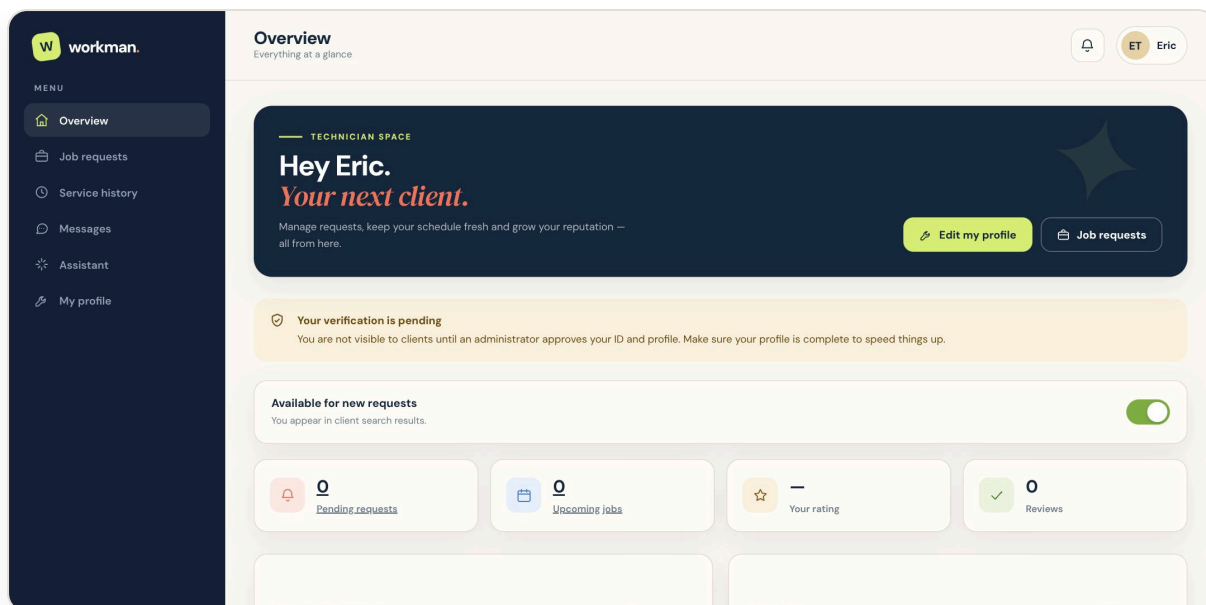


Figure 21. What a new technician sees while waiting for approval (`eric@workman.local`).

14.2 Setting up your profile — My profile

Complete every section — a full profile gets approved faster and receives more bookings. Each section has its own save button.

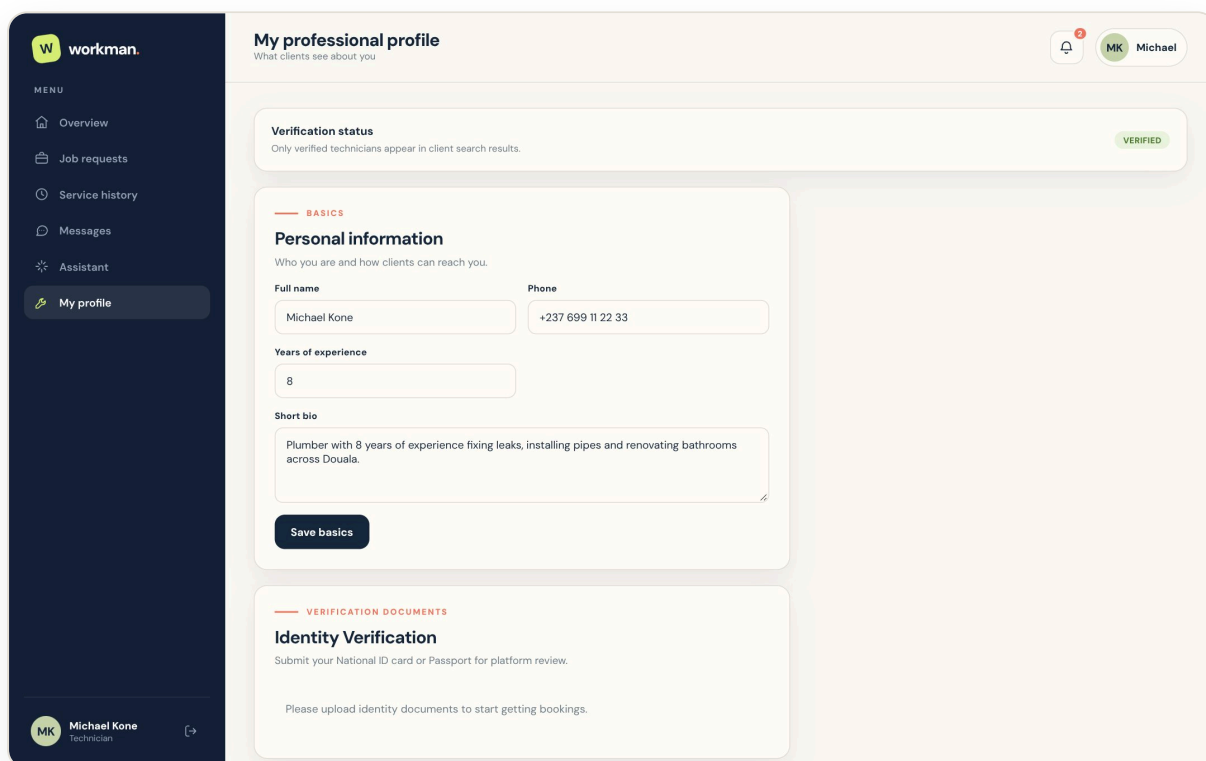


Figure 22. My professional profile.

Section	What to do
Personal information	Full name, phone, years of experience and a short bio. Click Save basics .
Identity verification	Upload your National ID or passport (JPG, PNG, PDF, max 5 MB) with Upload ID document . An administrator checks it before approving you.
Services you offer	Pick a category, enter a service name (e.g. "Leak repair") and a starting price in FCFA, then Add service . Remove a service with its X. If your trade is missing, type it in Request a custom category — an administrator will review it.
Where you work	Add each city and (optionally) neighbourhood you cover, e.g. Douala · Akwa, with Add service area . Clients filter by these.
Your weekly schedule	Switch each day on/off and set start and end times, then Save working hours . Clients can only book inside these hours.

14.3 Handling job requests — Job requests

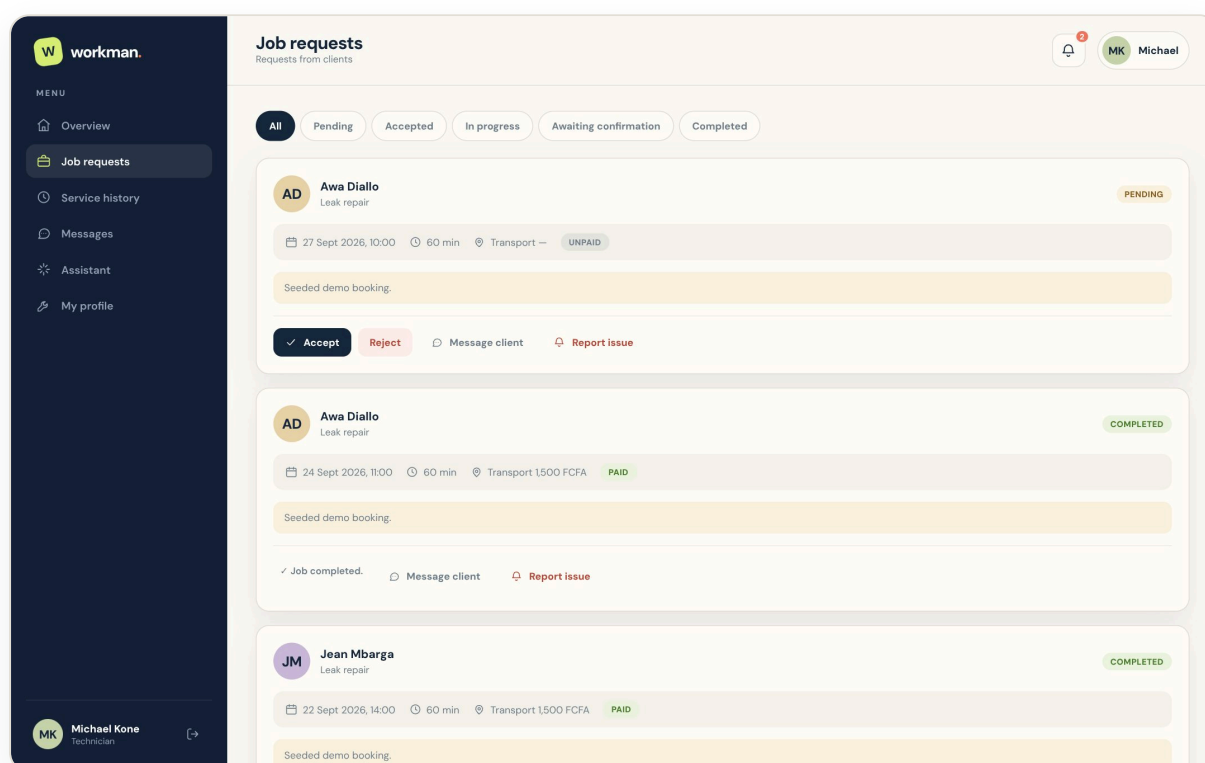


Figure 23. Job requests with Accept / Reject.

Filter with the tabs **All**, **Pending**, **Accepted**, **In progress**, **Awaiting confirmation**, **Completed**. Then work through each job:

- 1. Accept or reject.** On a **PENDING** request click **Accept**, enter the **transport fee (FCFA)** the client must pay before you travel, and confirm with **Accept booking**. Or click **Reject**.
- 2. Wait for payment.** The client pays the transport fee into escrow and releases it when you arrive. Until then the card shows "Waiting for the client to release the transport payment".
- 3. Start the job.** Click **Start job** — the status becomes **IN PROGRESS**.
- 4. Share your location** while travelling with **Share location** → **Share my location** (allow the browser prompt) so the client can follow you.

5. **Finish.** Click **Mark work done**. The client confirms completion and can leave a review.

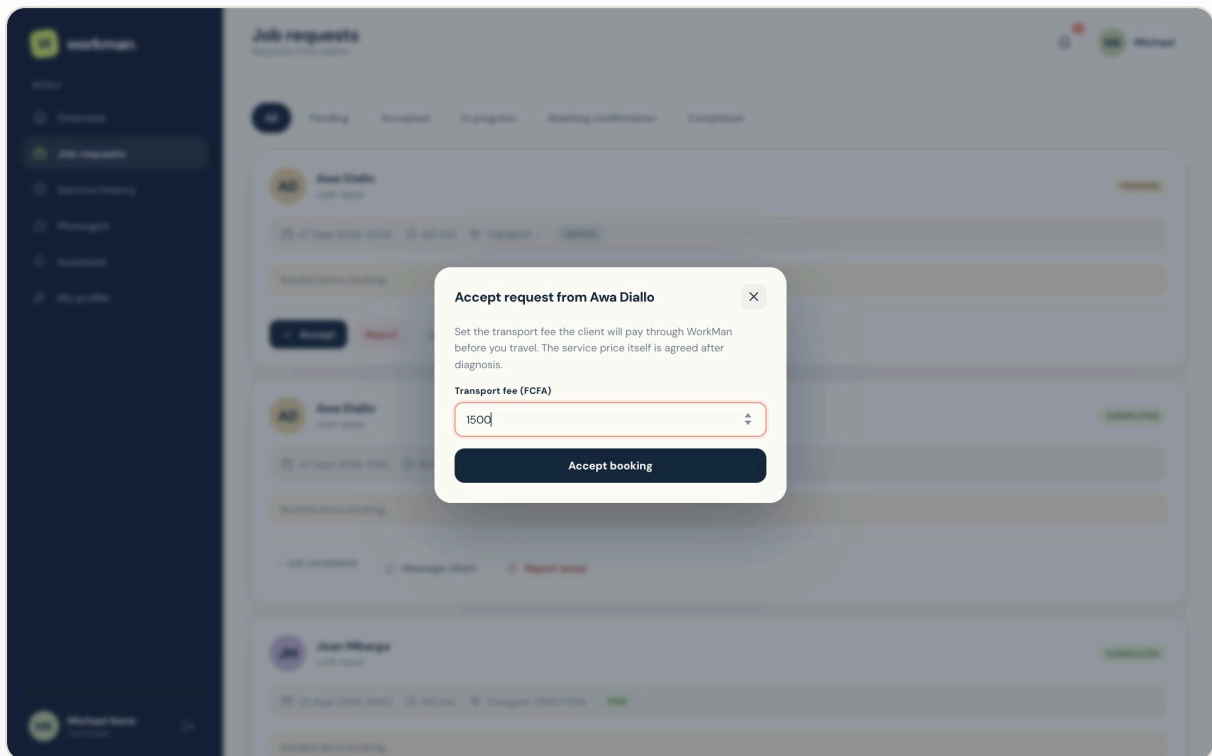


Figure 24. Setting the transport fee when accepting a booking.

Every job card also has **Message client** and **Report issue**.

14.4 Service history

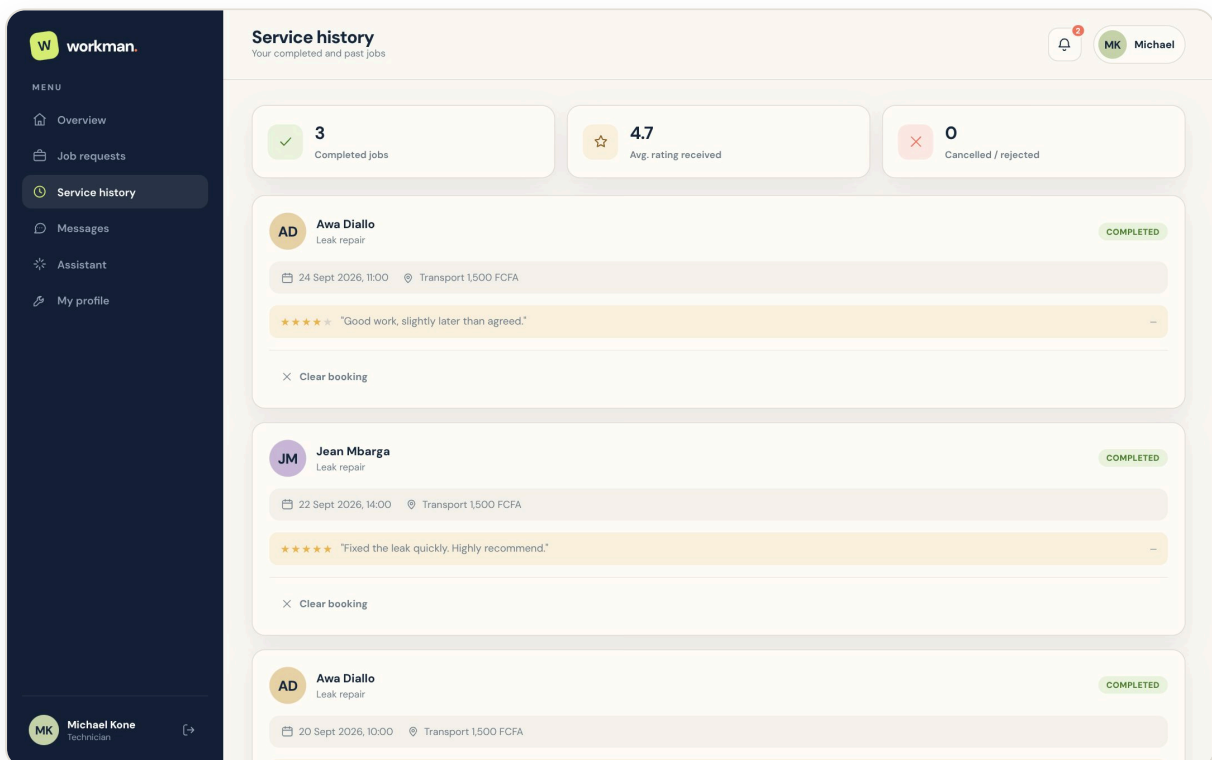


Figure 25. Completed and past jobs with the ratings you received.

Service history is a read-only record of your completed and cancelled jobs, with totals and your average rating. **Clear booking** removes a job from the list.

14.5 Messages & Assistant

These work exactly as for clients (sections 13.12 and 13.13): chat privately with your clients, and ask the Technician assistant how to accept jobs, update availability or get verified.

Administrator *guide*

Keep the platform trustworthy. Log in with `admin@workman.local`.

15.1 Overview

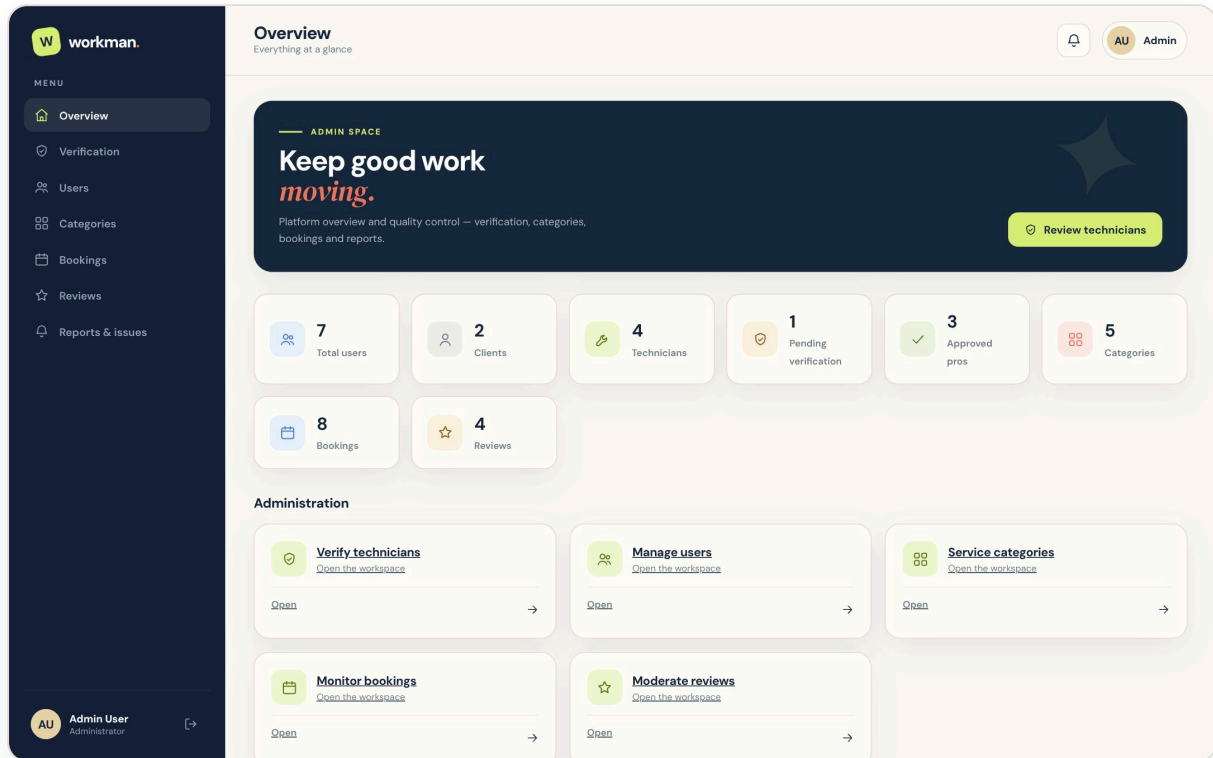


Figure 26. Platform statistics and administration shortcuts.

Counters for total users, clients, technicians, **pending verifications**, approved technicians, categories, bookings and reviews, followed by shortcuts to each administration page. **Review technicians** jumps straight to the queue.

15.2 Verification — approving technicians

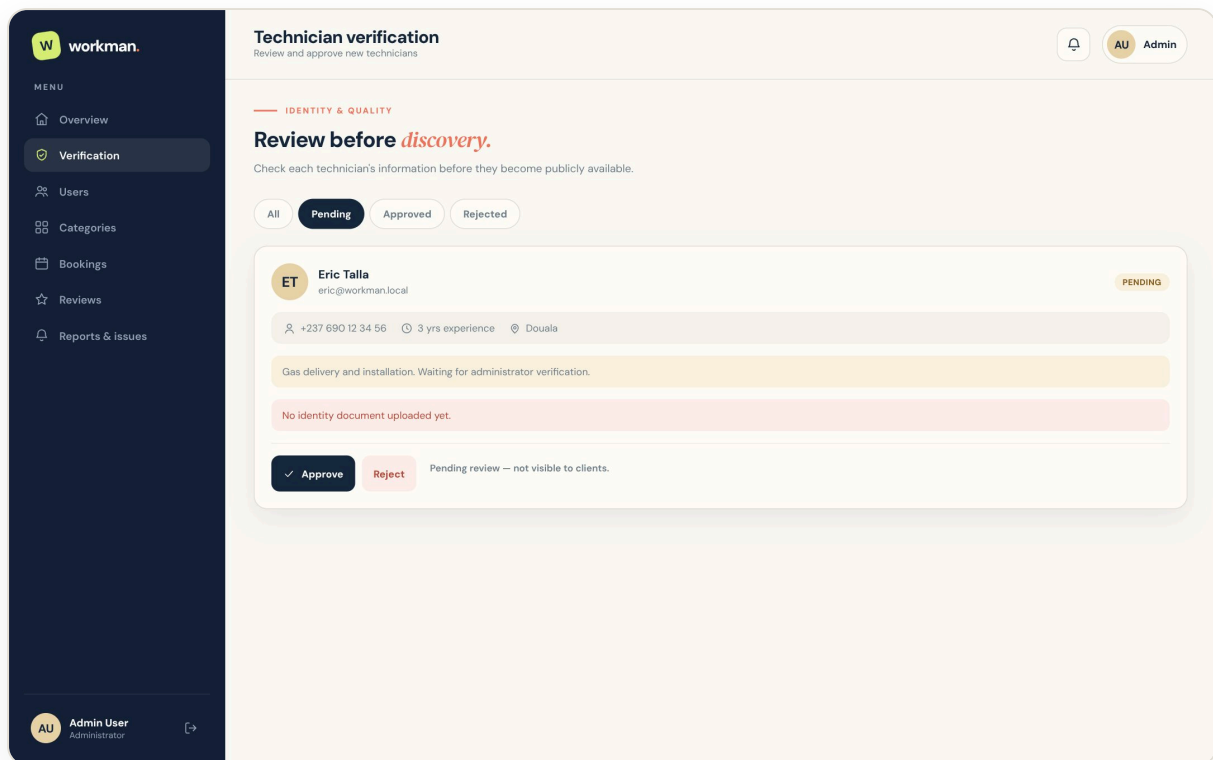


Figure 27. Reviewing a technician before they become visible.

1. Open **Verification**. The **Pending** tab lists technicians waiting for review (tabs: All / Pending / Approved / Rejected).
2. Check the phone, experience, city and bio, and open the uploaded **identity document** (a warning is shown if none was uploaded).
3. Click **Approve** — the technician immediately appears in client searches — or **Reject**.

15.3 Users

Users
Everyone on the platform

Search users by name or email...

All Clients Technicians Administrators

USER	ROLE	STATUS	JOINED	ACTIONS
MK Michael Kone michael@workman.local	TECHNICIAN	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate
FN Fatou Ndiaye fatou@workman.local	TECHNICIAN	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate
SB Samuel Bate samuel@workman.local	TECHNICIAN	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate
ET Eric Talla eric@workman.local	TECHNICIAN	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate
AU Admin User admin@workman.local	ADMINISTRATOR	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	
AD Awa Diallo client@workman.local	CLIENT	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate
JM Jean Mbarga jean@workman.local	CLIENT	ACTIVE	26 Sept 2026	Deactivate

Figure 28. Everyone on the platform.

Search by name or email and filter with the tabs **All / Clients / Technicians / Administrators**. Click **Deactivate** to block an account (the person can no longer log in) and **Reactivate** to restore it.

15.4 Categories

Service categories
The services clients can choose

SERVICE DIRECTORY

What clients can *choose*.
Categories power the search filters on the client side.

Category name: e.g. Plumbing
Description (optional): Leaks, repairs & installations

+ Create category

CATEGORY	SLUG	STATUS	ACTIONS
Plumbing Leaks, repairs & installations	plumbing	ACTIVE	Deactivate
Electrical work Safe fixes for every circuit	electrical	ACTIVE	Deactivate
Carpentry Furniture, fittings & more	carpentry	ACTIVE	Deactivate
Gas delivery Reliable delivery to your door	gas	ACTIVE	Deactivate
Laundry Fresh clothes, less effort	laundry	ACTIVE	Deactivate

Figure 29. Managing service categories.

- **Create** a category with a name and optional description, then click **Create category**.

- Categories requested by technicians show **PENDING REVIEW** with **Approve** / **Reject**.
- **Deactivate** hides a category from clients without deleting it; **Activate** brings it back; the red bin icon deletes it.

15.5 Bookings, Reviews and Reports

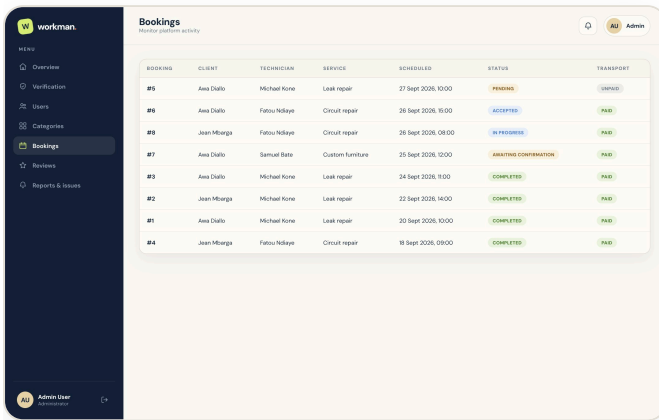


Figure 30. Monitoring all bookings.

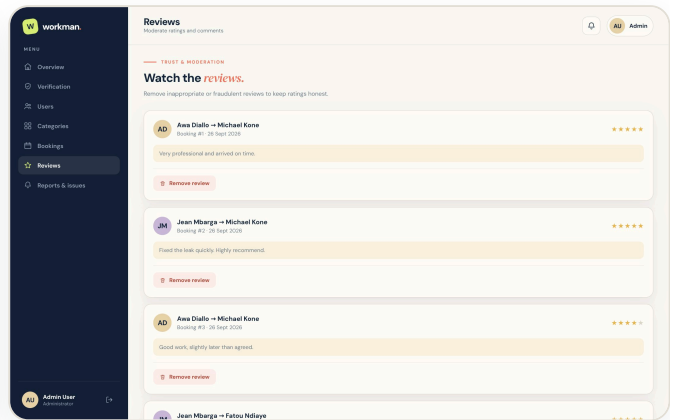


Figure 31. Review moderation.

- **Bookings** — a read-only view of every booking on the platform with client, technician, service, date, transport fee and status.
- **Reviews** — read all ratings and comments; click **Remove review** to delete an abusive or fake review (the technician's rating is recalculated).
- **Reports & issues** — issues submitted by clients and technicians, with reporter, type, description, date and status. Write **Admin resolution notes** and click **Mark as Resolved**.

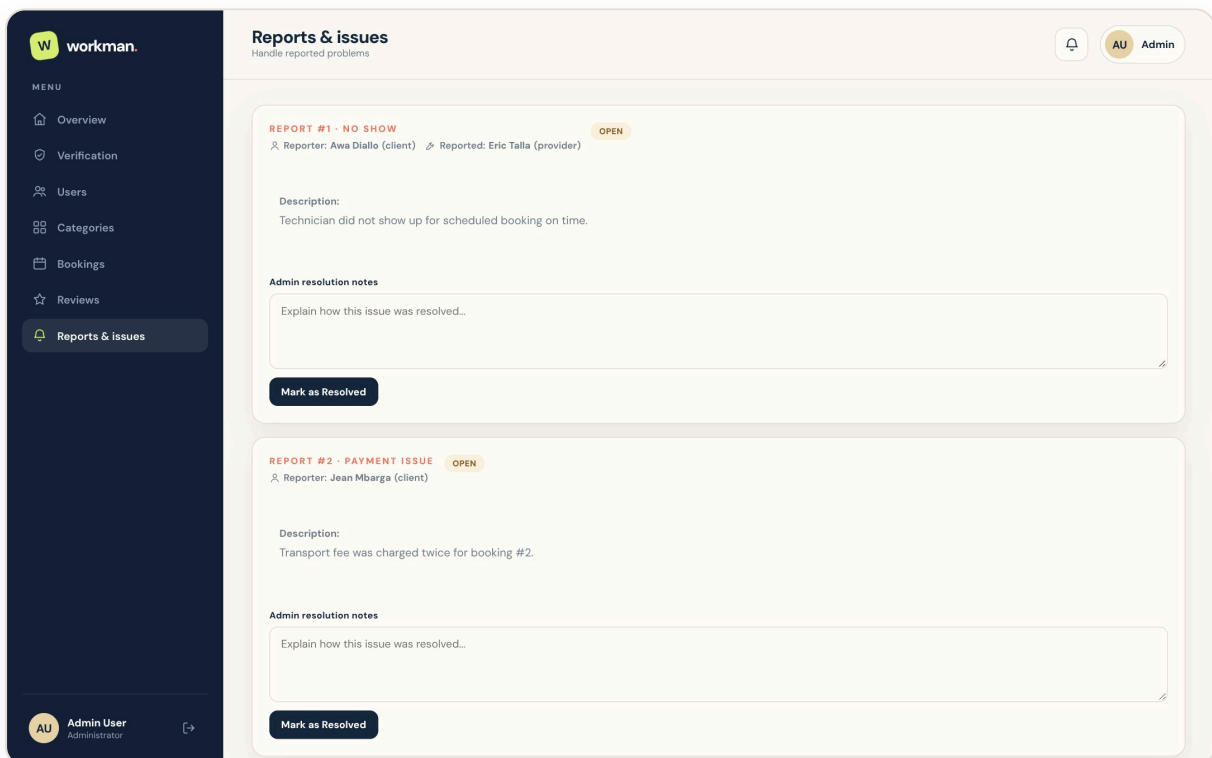


Figure 32. Reports & issues.

A booking from *start to finish*

Follow these steps with two browser windows — one as `client@workman.local`, one as `michael@workman.local` — to see the whole platform working together.



Side exits: a client can cancel while **Pending** (**CANCELLED**); a technician can decline while **Pending** (**REJECTED**).

#	Who	Action	Result
1	Client	Find a technician → open Michael Kone's profile → Chat to describe the leak.	Conversation in Messages
2	Client	Book → choose "Leak repair", a time inside his working hours, address → Send booking request .	PENDING ; technician notified
3	Technician	Job requests → Accept → transport fee e.g. 1 500 FCFA → Accept booking .	ACCEPTED ; client notified
4	Client	My bookings → Pay transport fee → MTN MoMo / Orange Money → pay.	Payment HELD IN ESCROW
5	Technician	Share location → Share my location while travelling.	Client sees him on the map
6	Client	Track technician ; when he arrives → Release transport payment .	Payment RELEASED
7	Technician	Start job , diagnose, agree the service price, do the work → Mark work done .	AWAITING CONFIRMATION
8	Client	Confirm completion → optionally Pay service fee .	COMPLETED
9	Client	Give 1–5 stars and a comment → Submit review .	Rating shown on profile
10	Admin	Sees the booking in Bookings and the review in Reviews ; handles any report.	Platform stays trustworthy

Page & route map

Every page of the website and who can open it. Type the address after `http://localhost:5173`.

Address	Who	Page
/	Everyone	Home page
/login · /register	Everyone	Log in · Create an account
/dashboard	All signed-in users	Overview (different for each role)
/dashboard/discover	Client	Find a technician
/dashboard/technicians/:id	Client	Technician profile, chat, booking
/dashboard/bookings	Client	My bookings & payments
/dashboard/favorites	Client	Favorites
/dashboard/settings	Client	Personal information & ID upload
/dashboard/messages	Client, Technician	Messages
/dashboard/assistant	Client, Technician	Help assistant
/dashboard/tracking/:bookingId	Client, Technician	Live GPS tracking
/dashboard/jobs	Technician	Job requests
/dashboard/history	Technician	Service history
/dashboard/profile-setup	Technician	My professional profile
/dashboard/verification	Administrator	Technician verification
/dashboard/users	Administrator	Users
/dashboard/categories	Administrator	Service categories
/dashboard/platform-bookings	Administrator	All bookings
/dashboard/reviews	Administrator	Review moderation
/dashboard/reports	Administrator	Reports & issues

Testing the API with Postman

The `postman/` folder contains a collection that walks the whole platform — all three roles and the full booking lifecycle (32 requests, 83 assertions). With the backend running and freshly seeded:

```
$ php artisan migrate:fresh --seed          # in backend/ - start from clean demo data
$ npx newman run postman/workman-api.postman_collection.json  # from the project root
```

Or import `postman/workman-api.postman_collection.json` into the Postman app and use the Collection Runner. API requests authenticate with `Authorization: Bearer <token>`, where the token is returned by `POST /api/auth/login`. The full route list is in `backend/routes/api.php`.

NEED HELP?

See the `README.md` files in the project root, `backend/`, `frontend/` and `postman/` for developer-level details.